

$> 90 \%$

of intercontinental traffic
rides submarine cables

0.17 dB/km

best fibre at 1550 nm: half
the light survives 17 km

$\sim 50 \text{ THz}$

low-loss window of
one strand of glass

250 Tb/s

design capacity of one
transatlantic cable (Dunant)

-48 V

on a telephone pair,
as in the 1890s

$> 10^7 \times$

growth of home access rates,
300 b/s to 10 Gb/s

$\sim 1 \text{ Gb/s}$

G.fast over 50 m of
old telephone wire

$\sim 10 \text{ photons}$

per bit: the quantum
limit at BER 10^{-9}